Using the Daily Reader App Starter Project

Before asking Codex to change the Daily Reader app, make sure the practice project is on your computer and running locally.

- Key concept:**Use the starter project for the lessons.** The complete project is there as a reference if you want to compare your work later.

Step 1: Download the project files

Open the **Course Files** tab for this course and download:

Starter Projects – Codex Intro

- Use it to follow the course exercises.

Complete Projects – Codex Intro

- Use it only as a reference of the complete work.

After downloading the starter ZIP, unzip it on your computer.

Step 2: Open the App Reader project

For the first real task, open this folder in Visual Studio Code:

📁 Starter Projects - Codex Intro

📁 Daily Reader App

📁 react_project ← open **this** folder

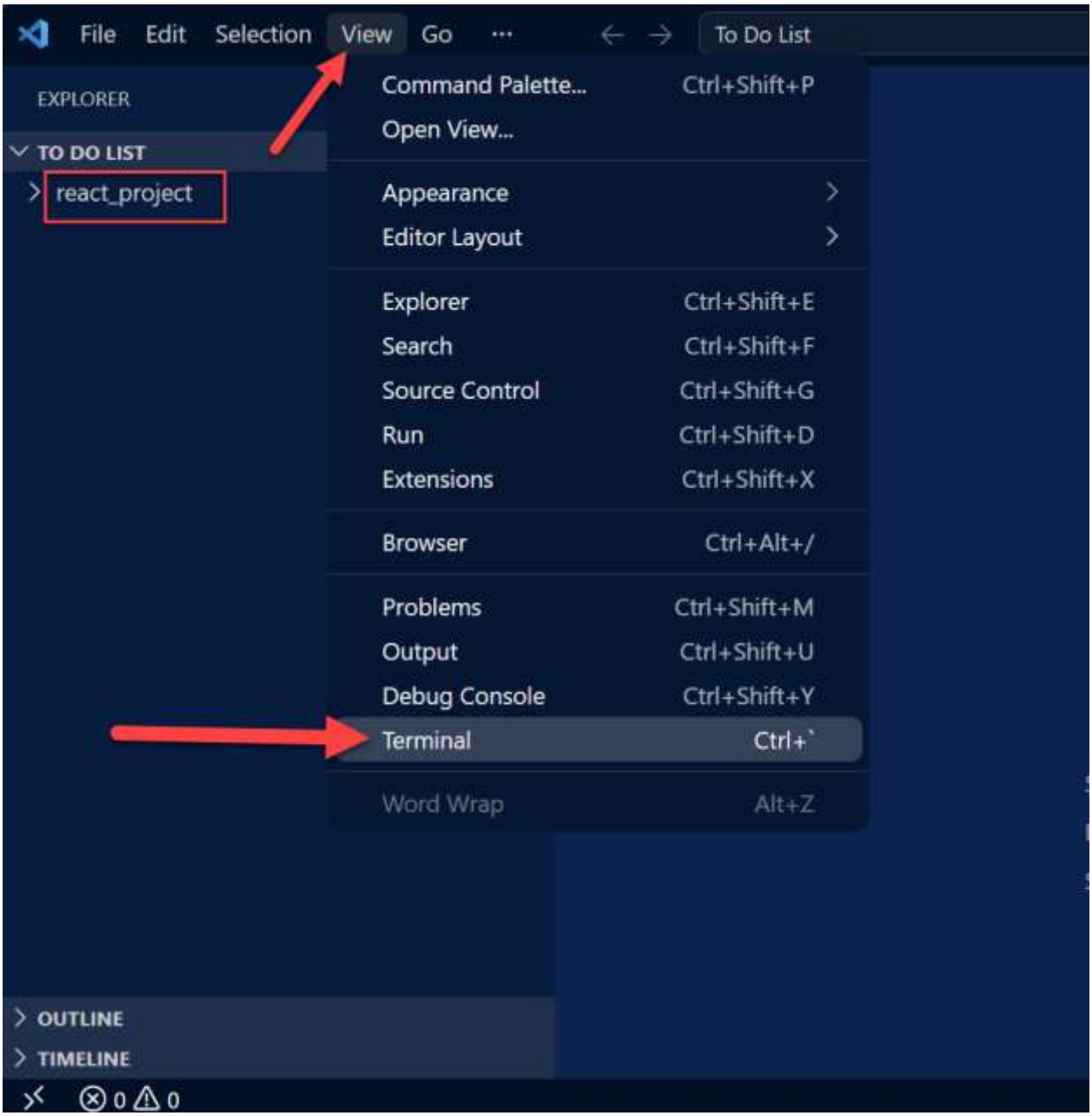
Make sure you open the react_project folder itself. This is the folder that contains package.json.

- Note:**What is package.json?** It is a small settings file for the project. It tells Node.js which tools the app needs and which commands you can run, such as npm run dev.

Step 3: Run the app locally

- Key concept:**Node.js note.** Node.js is optional for installing Codex with the native installer, but it is needed to run this React project locally.

Open the VS Code terminal while you are inside the react_project folder:



Then, in the **Terminal**, we will run npm like so:

npm install

npm run dev

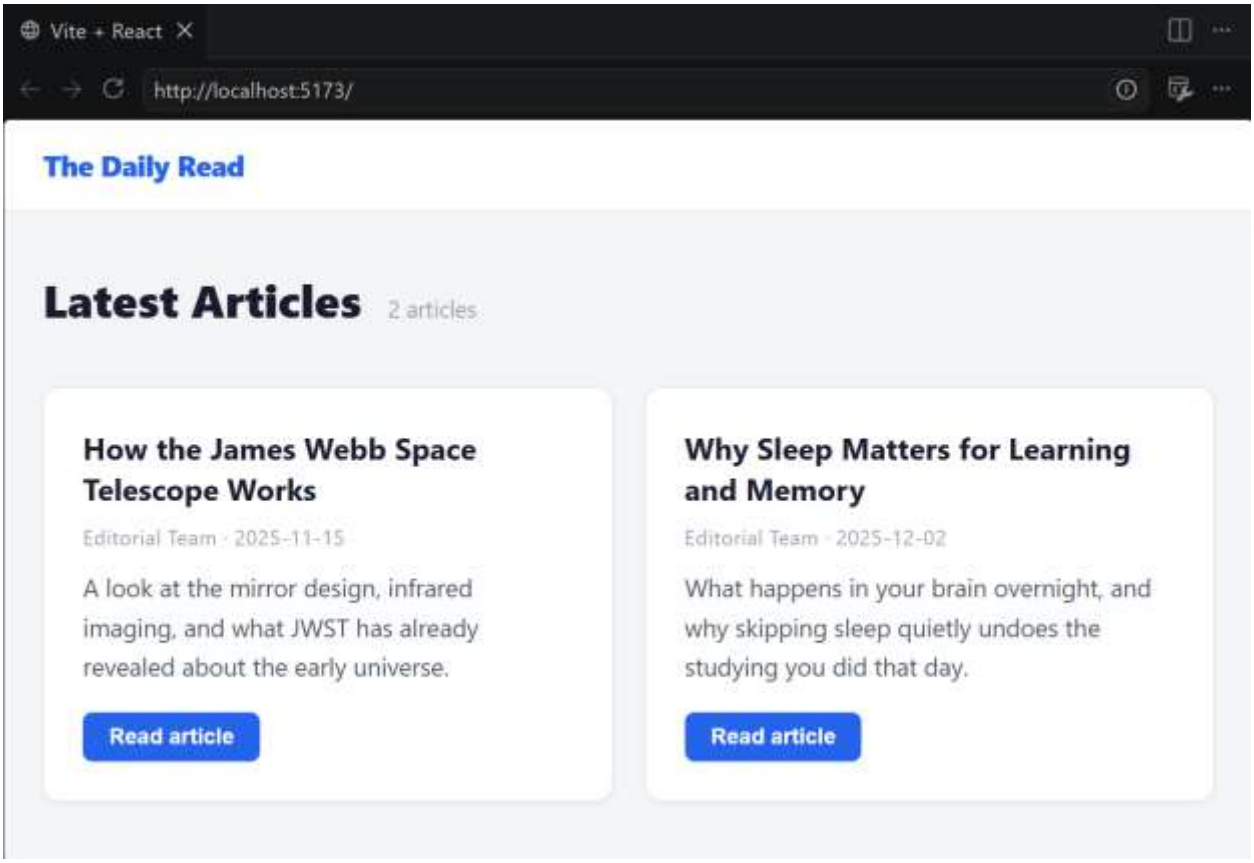
- Note:**What is npm?** npm is the tool that downloads the project tools listed in package.json and runs commands for the app. npm is included in the official Node.js installer.

The terminal will show a local URL, usually:

http://localhost:5173

Open that URL in your browser. Keep the terminal running while you work on the app.

You should see the App Reader app in your browser.



Step 4: Start Codex in the same folder

In the project terminal, start Codex:

codex

Codex should start inside the same react_project folder.

Step 5: Save a safe starting point

Before Codex changes the project, create a Git checkpoint:

git init

git add .

git commit -m "Initial starter project"

After Codex makes changes, you can review them with:

git diff

If something does not work

- Do:
- If npm is not found, install Node.js from https://nodejs.org/download and try again.
- If npm install fails, check that your terminal is inside the react_project folder.
- If the browser does not show the app, use the exact local URL printed in your terminal.
- If Codex cannot find the files, start Codex from the same react_project folder.

Once the app is running and Codex Code is open in the project folder, continue to the next lesson.